

in net income. Legal service providers, on average, would need to generate \$414,800 in sales to earn what the average coal mine operation earned in net income.

What will you advise David and Christy to do? If you're like most successful business owners, you will advise them to become professionals. So it is with the affluent in America. The first-generation affluent are typically entrepreneurs. They beat the odds. Their businesses succeed, and they become affluent. Much of their success depends on their living a frugal existence while building their businesses. Luck is often involved. And most who succeed understand that circumstances could have gone against them.

TABLE 8-2
THE TOP TEN MOST PROFITABLE¹ SOLE-PROPRIETORSHIP
BUSINESSES